

The Weight of Words*

*The Extended Version

All ten works from [Chronicle I](#) are available in the [AuroraChronicles Books archive](#).

The collection features the following 6 stories:

A Tale of Two Perspectives
A Balanced Life
The Fault Lines
The Needs We Carry
The Weight of Expectations
The Weight of Words

View the source on [GitHub](#) or read it online on [GitHub Pages](#).

They sat on the faded couch in her living room, sunlight pooling through the window like golden syrup. Amir and Lila had spent hours talking—about silly dreams, fleeting moments of school gossip, and the meaning of life as only teenagers could imagine it. Conversations had always been their thread of connection, a rhythm they both understood.

"You talk too much," Lila teased, a sly grin playing on her lips as she leaned back. "Why don't you just get comfy for once? You're always thinking."

Something about her words—light and casual—settled into Amir's mind. He let his shoulders loosen, sank deeper into the couch, and let silence spread. For once, he didn't fight to fill the gaps with words.

It was strange at first. Silence felt heavier than speech, but Amir began to enjoy it. It was as though he was learning something new: he didn't have to try. He could simply be. The less he said, the more relaxed he felt. He let the world blur, focusing on himself and his books, folding further into comfort over the next few days.

But Lila noticed the change. The boy who used to talk endlessly now barely spoke. She thought of that moment on the couch, her own words echoing back to her: "Get comfy." Had she opened a door she didn't want him to step through? She didn't know.

Over time, they drifted—quietly, painfully. Amir's days became consumed by textbooks and exams. He spent hours studying, absorbed in his own things, leaving Lila behind like an untied shoelace.

"What happened to us?" she asked one evening when she caught him in the hallway.

Amir blinked, confused. "What do you mean? I'm just studying."

"You're always studying. You don't even talk to me anymore," she snapped, her voice trembling. "You're so comfortable with your books that I don't even exist."

Amir frowned. "I thought you wanted me to relax. You said it yourself. I'm just focusing on what's important right now."

"And I'm not important?" she shot back. The silence that followed was colder than it had ever been.

That night, Amir lay awake in his room, staring at the ceiling. He thought of Lila's words and how much they had meant before. He wondered if he really had done anything wrong. People drift apart, he reasoned. Isn't that normal?

But a small, nagging voice inside him disagreed.

Words. That's what relationships lived on. Before, conversations had been like oxygen between them—filling spaces, creating life. By choosing silence, by indulging in comfort, he had suffocated something fragile without realizing it. He had focused so much on being fine that he'd forgotten how important connection was.

The next day, Amir found Lila sitting on the same couch, arms crossed. He sat beside her, awkward at first, but he forced himself to speak.

"I'm sorry," he said quietly. "I didn't mean to push you away."

Lila glanced at him, her face softening. "I just miss you, Amir. That's all."

They didn't fix everything in that moment. But for the first time in weeks, they began to talk—one word at a time—building a bridge they both needed.

It turned out words weren't just words. They were anchors, connections, lifelines. And sometimes, all it took was one simple "sorry" to begin again.

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Daniel waited outside the classroom with a notebook pressed against his chest. When his friend Maya finally came out, he held it toward her. "I wrote something," he said. "Will you read it?"

They sat beneath the old tree behind the school while Maya read. Daniel watched her turn each page, trying to hide how badly he wanted her approval. He had spent weeks on the story, staying awake late to rewrite sentences and imagining what it would feel like to see his name in a book someday.

Maya closed the notebook and looked at him. She was tired, irritated with him after an argument earlier that day, and perhaps a little jealous of the confidence he had in his dream. Without thinking, she handed the notebook back. "You're not good enough to be a writer."

Daniel's smile disappeared for just a moment. Then he nodded. "Okay." He put the notebook into his bag, and neither of them mentioned the story again.

The next week, Daniel didn't enter the writing competition. The week after that, he stopped bringing his notebook to school. Maya noticed, but she never connected it to anything she had said; she simply assumed he had lost interest. Soon they graduated, made new friends, and carried on with their own lives.

Years later, Maya walked into a bookstore on a rainy afternoon and noticed a familiar face behind a table of newly published books. She recognized Daniel immediately, though it took her a moment to realize the book in front of him had his name on it.

"You became a writer," she said, smiling in surprise.

Daniel smiled back. "Eventually."

Maya picked up the book and turned it over in her hands. "I always knew you had it in you," she said, almost laughing at the coincidence.

Daniel looked at her for a moment. "Did you?"

She frowned slightly, not understanding.

"You once told me I wasn't good enough to be a writer."

Maya went still. She searched her memory, but nothing came. The sentence had vanished from her mind years ago, so completely that she couldn't even remember saying it. "I said that?"

Daniel nodded.

"I don't remember."

"I know," he said softly. "That's what made it hurt."

Maya looked down at the book. For the first time, she understood that the words she had forgotten had become something Daniel had carried with him for years. What had been a passing sentence to her had become a voice in his head, waiting at the edge of every blank page.

"I almost stopped writing," Daniel said. "For a long time, whenever I doubted myself, I could hear those words again. Then one day I realized I couldn't spend my life letting a sentence I barely remembered decide what I could become."

Maya looked at his name on the cover again. She had forgotten seven words. Daniel had spent years proving them wrong.

And perhaps that was the real weight of words: the person who speaks them may forget them completely, while the person who hears them may carry them for the rest of their life.

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Arjun stood outside the examination hall staring at the results sheet in his hands. He had failed again. Around him, students were calling their parents, laughing, comparing marks, already making plans for the next step. Arjun folded the paper and slipped it into his pocket before anyone could see.

He went home quietly and sat on the stairs outside his room. His father found him there but didn't ask about the result. He simply sat beside him for a while. After a long silence, he said, "One result can tell you what happened today. It doesn't get to tell you who you are."

Arjun looked at him but said nothing. His father didn't give him advice or tell him that everything would be fine. He only repeated, "This is a setback, not a definition."

The words stayed with Arjun. On the difficult days that followed, when studying felt pointless and every mistake seemed to prove that he wasn't capable, he remembered them. Slowly, he began again—not because the failure had become easier, but because his father's words had given him somewhere to stand.

Years later, Arjun was sitting across from a young student who had just failed an important examination. The boy stared at the floor, convinced that one piece of paper had decided his future. Arjun listened, then smiled and said, "One result can tell you what happened today. It doesn't get to tell you who you are."

The boy looked up.

Arjun realized then that his father had spoken those words only once, perhaps without knowing how deeply they would settle inside him. Some words are not meant to be remembered because they are beautiful; they are remembered because, at the moment they are spoken, someone needs them to survive.

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Nora stood at the front door with a suitcase in her hand. She had just told her brother that she was leaving home to study in another city, expecting him to argue, question her decision, or at least ask her to stay. Instead, he looked away and said, "Do whatever you want."

She waited for something more, but nothing came. The words felt colder than she expected. Angry and hurt, she picked up her suitcase and walked out without saying goodbye.

For the next three years, Nora carried those four words with her. Whenever she missed home, she remembered them. Whenever she thought about calling her brother, she heard them again—Do whatever you want. With time, the words began to mean more than he had actually said. In her mind, they became I don't care, You don't matter, Go if you want.

Then their mother fell ill, and Nora returned home. One evening, while searching through an old cupboard,

she found an envelope with her name written across it in her brother's handwriting. She stared at it for a long moment, but her old anger returned. She didn't open it. Whatever he had to say now, she thought, couldn't erase what he had said then.

Weeks passed. Her mother's condition slowly improved, and life began settling into something almost ordinary again. One afternoon, Nora found the envelope on the same shelf. This time, she opened it.

The letter had been written on the night she left.

I wanted to ask you to stay, it began. I wanted to tell you that I'm scared of losing you. But I also know that if I make you stay because I'm afraid, you may spend years wondering what your life could have been. So go. Choose your life. I'll miss you, but I'll always be here when you come home.

Nora read the letter twice. Then she sat quietly on the floor, thinking about all the years she had spent carrying four words while the words that explained them had been waiting in an unopened envelope.

That evening, she found her brother in the garden. She held out the letter. "I should have read this three years ago," she said.

He looked at it and smiled sadly. "I should have said it three years ago."

Neither of them tried to decide who was more at fault. There was nothing left to prove. Nora simply sat beside him, and for the first time in years, the silence between them didn't feel angry.

She had spent three years carrying words that were never meant to mean what she thought they did. And perhaps that was the danger of words—not only that we can say the wrong ones, but that we can hold onto the wrong meaning long after they are spoken.

We give words their weight by what we believe, what we remember, and what we choose to carry.

That night, Nora finally let four words go.